

Sample Indexed PDF

A 10+ page document with internal navigation, bookmarks, a table of contents, and an index

Generated on February 13, 2026

What's inside:

- Clickable **Table of Contents** (TOC) and PDF outline
- **Index** with alphabetic headers and page links
- Reusable **page templates** (cover vs. normal pages)
- Examples of tables, callouts, and a small diagram

Tip: Open the left sidebar in your PDF reader to see the outline bookmarks.

Table of Contents

Entries are generated automatically from Heading 1 and Heading 2 styles.

1. Overview	3
1.1 Why indexing matters	3
1.2 Document pipeline	3
1.3 Quick checklist	4
2. Table of Contents and Bookmarks	5
2.1 Heading levels	5
2.2 Bookmark destinations	5
2.3 Example snippet	5
2.4 Navigation tips	6
3. Building an Index	7
3.1 Marking terms in the text	7
3.2 What gets indexed	7
3.3 Sample term list	7
3.4 Multi-pass build requirement	8
4. Layout and Page Templates	9
4.1 Frames and margins	9
4.2 Reusable headers and footers	9
4.3 Styling guidelines	9
4.4 Appendix: Mini glossary	10
Index	11
About this sample	13

1. Overview

This chapter introduces **Overview**. The text is intentionally concise and formatted to show headings, internal links, and index entries.

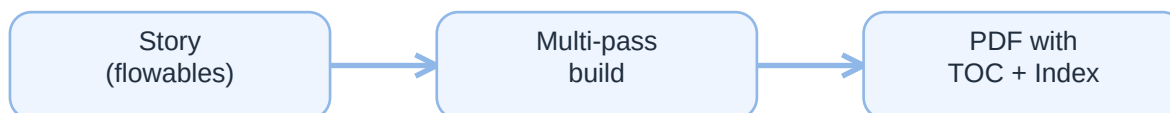
1.1 Why indexing matters

In longer documents, **indexing** means more than page numbers: it is the combination of structure (headings), navigation (links/bookmarks), and a curated list of key terms at the end.

- A TOC answers “where is this section?”
- An index answers “where is this topic mentioned?”
- PDF outline bookmarks provide a fast, collapsible navigation tree

1.2 Document pipeline

This diagram summarizes the build pipeline used by ReportLab/Platypus. It highlights the multi-pass process required for TOC and index generation.



Note: A multi-pass build is required because the TOC and index need final page numbers after layout is known.

1.3 Quick checklist

If you are generating PDFs programmatically, a helpful checklist is:

- Use consistent heading styles and register them in `afterFlowable()`
- Create bookmarks for headings and wire them into the TOC
- Insert index markers where terms first appear
- Run `multiBuild()` so page numbers are accurate
- Review output as images to catch layout issues

The rest of this sample walks through these ideas with concrete examples.

2. Table of Contents and Bookmarks

This chapter introduces **Table of Contents and Bookmarks**. The text is intentionally concise and formatted to show headings, internal links, and index entries.

2.1 Heading levels

The TOC is generated from headings. In this sample, **Heading 1** becomes a top-level entry and **Heading 2** becomes an indented sub-entry.

Style	Purpose	TOC level
Heading 1	Chapter title	0
Heading 2	Section title	1
Body	Main text	—

2.2 Bookmark destinations

Each heading is assigned a unique destination key. The TOC entry points to that destination, and the PDF outline uses the same key.

Implementation detail: in `afterFlowable()`, call `canv.bookmarkPage(key)` and `canv.addOutlineEntry(...)`.

2.3 Example snippet

```
doc.notify("TOCEntry", (level, text, pageNum, key))
canv.bookmarkPage(key)
canv.addOutlineEntry(text, key, level=level)
```

2.4 Navigation tips

Most PDF readers show the outline panel. On desktop, it is often a sidebar icon. The TOC and index entries are clickable, so you can jump directly to the relevant page.

- Try clicking a TOC entry on the Table of Contents page.
- Use the outline to jump between chapters.
- Scroll to the Index at the end and click a topic.

If your reader does not display links, ensure you are not in a print-preview mode.

3. Building an Index

This chapter introduces **Building an Index**. The text is intentionally concise and formatted to show headings, internal links, and index entries.

3.1 Marking terms in the text

Index entries are created by embedding an inline marker such as `<index item="Typography"/>`. You can add markers for multiple terms in the same paragraph.

Example: "We applied consistent typography and spacing."

3.2 What gets indexed

A practical index is curated. Index terms should correspond to concepts readers might search for, not every noun in the document. This sample indexes a small set of topics like **Flowables**, **Frames**, and **Hyperlinks**.

- **Flowables** are the building blocks of Platypus layouts
- **Frames** define where content can be placed on a page
- **Hyperlinks** are created automatically by TOC and index entries

3.3 Sample term list

Indexed term	Where it appears
ReportLab	Chapter 1
Table of Contents	Front matter + Chapter 2
Frames	Chapter 3 and 4
Page templates	Chapter 4

3.4 Multi-pass build requirement

Because page numbers are determined during layout, index pages are not final until the document has been built at least twice. Platypus handles this automatically when you call `multiBuild()`.

In practice: build once to collect headings and index locations, then build again to render the final TOC and index.

This sample is designed to be readable while still producing enough material to span multiple pages.

Headings appear in the table of contents and the PDF outline, and they can be clicked for navigation.

Index terms are embedded throughout the body and collected into an alphabetized index at the end.

The layout uses consistent typography, generous spacing, and unobtrusive header and footer elements.

4. Layout and Page Templates

This chapter introduces **Layout and Page Templates**. The text is intentionally concise and formatted to show headings, internal links, and index entries.

4.1 Frames and margins

A page template defines one or more frames: rectangular regions where content flows. Margins prevent text from colliding with headers and footers.

4.2 Reusable headers and footers

This sample draws a light header and footer on all normal pages. The header includes the document title and the current chapter. The footer includes the page number.

Tip: For a cover page, use a separate template without the header/footer.

4.3 Styling guidelines

- Limit line length and use whitespace to separate sections
- Keep headings visually distinct but consistent across the document
- Use tables and callouts sparingly to highlight structure

4.4 Appendix: Mini glossary

Flowable — A layout element such as a paragraph, image, table, or spacer.

Frame — A rectangular region on the page into which flowables are placed.

Page template — A combination of frames plus header/footer drawing callbacks.

Bookmark — A named destination used for internal links and PDF outlines.

Index — An alphabetized list of topics with page references.

Next: the generated index. Click any entry to jump to the first occurrence.

Index

The index below is generated from inline `<index item="..." />` markers throughout the document.

A

afterFlowable 5

B

Bookmark 10

Bookmarks 5

bookmarks 3

D

destination 5

F

Flowable 10

Flowables 7

footer 9

Footers 9

Frame 10

Frames 7

frames 9

H

header 9

Headers 9

Heading 1 5

Heading 2 5

Hyperlinks 7

I

Index 3, 10

index markers 7

Index terms 7

indexing 3

M

margins	9
multi-pass build	3
multiBuild	8

N

Navigation	3
----------------------	---

O

Outline	3
outline tree	5

P

page numbers	9
Page template	10
Page templates	9

R

ReportLab	3
---------------------	---

S

SimpleIndex	7
-----------------------	---

T

Table of Contents	5
table of contents	3
tables	9
Typography	7
typography	9

W

whitespace	9
----------------------	---

About this sample

This document was generated programmatically and is intended as a compact, readable example of:

- Automatic TOC entries and internal destinations
- Outline bookmarks in the PDF viewer
- An index generated from inline markers
- Consistent page templates and typography

If you want a different theme (e.g., corporate branding, a technical report style, or a thesis layout), tell me the colors/fonts and the section structure you prefer.